

SEALED — OPEN ONLY ONCE YOU ARE CLEAR OF THE
KOMTUR.

(You tear it open in the shadow of the walls, out of his sight.)

So that was the list.

We saw it the moment he drew it out — that strip of parchment he keeps at his side, names inked down one beneath another. "The Order forgets nothing," he said, almost laughing, holding it up like a man showing off his gold. He had no idea what he was showing us.

Those are the names of the Secret Council — every soul the Order has bought out of our own walls, written down and marked. That is what we should have come here for. Not words. That.

He will not part with it, but he does not guard it either. A man that proud never watches his own table. He turns away to point at his walls, he looks off to boast — and for a breath or two, the parchment lies there with no eyes on it.

We could take it. While his back is to it — never while he is looking, or he would have us by the wrist, and then we are thieves caught at the Order's own wall with no one to call. But when he turns...

Watch him. He moves the same way each time. Wait for the turn. Lift it clean. Walk — do not run, not until we have to.

And then we carry those names back. Everything after tonight turns on them.